

What is Earth?

Earth is our home. It is nearly 150 million km (94 million miles) from the Sun, and is the fifth-largest planet in our solar system. Earth is also the only planet in our solar system where water is found on the surface, which allows animals and plants to live there.

Solar system

Our solar system is made up of the Sun and the eight planets that travel around it – Mercury, Venus, Earth, Mars, Jupiter, Saturn, Uranus, and Neptune. The solar system also has moons, comets, asteroids, and meteoroids zipping through it. Scientists estimate that our solar system was formed about 4.6 billion years ago!

Day

In an area of the Earth that is facing the Sun, it will be light, and therefore day.

Sun's rays

As the Sun's rays reach Earth, they provide light and warmth. Without the Sun, life on Earth would not exist.

Equator

This is an imaginary line around the middle of the Earth. It lies halfway between the North and South Poles.

! WOW!

Our Sun is huge – about one million times bigger than the Earth!



Mercury



Venus



Earth



Mars